Syllabus Edition
First teaching 2025
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Answering 12-Mark Questions

Exam code: 0450, 0986 & 0264, 0774

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How do I answer a CIE IGCSE Business 12-mark justify question?

- These questions **only** appear in Paper 2
- You are required to **use the case study evidence** and **develop arguments**, reaching a **justified conclusion or recommendation**

The level of response marking grid

- 12-mark justify responses are assessed using a marking grid
- A mark is determined by considering how well, overall, the response demonstrates the skills of **knowledge, application, analysis** and **evaluation**
- The examiner uses the grid to find the best fit for the response

Level	Description
3 (9-12)	**Knowledge and Application** • Excellent knowledge and understanding of relevant business concepts using appropriate terminology in context **Analysis** • Detailed discussion of two or more points **Evaluation** • Well-justified recommendation **Guidance**

Help me understand
Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

	alternatives were rejected
2 **(5 – 8)**	**Knowledge and Application** • Good knowledge and understanding of relevant business concepts using appropriate terminology in context **Analysis** • Detailed discussion of at least one point **Evaluation** • Judgement with some justification / some evaluation of the choice made
1 **(1–4)**	**Knowledge and Application** • Limited knowledge and understanding of relevant business concepts in context **Analysis** • Limited ability to discuss the points with little or no explanation **Evaluation** • Simple judgement with limited justification or a limited evaluation of choice made
0	There is no creditable response.

Example

- The response below would achieve 12 marks as it
  - Discusses **a full range of points in detail**, in **context**
  - It includes a **well-justified recommendation**, explaining **why alternatives were rejected**

Consider the following three problems for SSM when entering markets in other countries: • **Cultural differences** • **Lack of knowledge** • **Import restrictions** **Which problem is likely to have the most effect on SSM? Justify your answer.**
Knowledge Application Analysis Evaluation

different scents, packaging or product features that SSM is not familiar with. This could require costly product development to make adaptations, extending the amount of time it would take to launch the product in the market. This could impact its ability to gain market share

Import restrictions like tariffs or quotas would increase costs or limit how much soap powder SSM could sell abroad. This would make it harder for SSM to compete on price with local manufacturers, especially with inflation rising, or sell in high enough volumes to achieve economies of scale. As a result SSM's profit margins are likely to be squeezed.

SSM has no experience selling outside country Y, so they lack understanding of consumer preferences, competitors, and distribution channels in foreign markets. There may be many existing manufacturers in Country Y. Without knowledge of these rivals' products, prices and market positioning, SSM would struggle to develop effective marketing strategies. They may also face challenges establishing relationships with new retailers or distributors

Of the three problems listed, lack of knowledge is likely to have the greatest effect on SSM's expansion plans. While SSM could conduct market research to gain knowledge, this is expensive and time-consuming and may not give them the knowledge they need. Cultural differences and import restrictions are tough problems, but they should be more easily addressed once SSM understands the new soap powder market. Therefore, lack of knowledge is likely to have the most significant impact on SSM's international expansion plans

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